

Online safety works best as an ongoing conversation. Use this guide together, adjust it as children grow, and keep it where everyone can see it.

For parents and guardians

☐ Talk regularly about apps, games, contacts, privacy, and what to do when something feels wrong.

☐ Use age-appropriate privacy, parental-control, and device-security settings.

☐ Teach children they can report problems **without being punished**.

☐ Know who your children communicate with online.

☐ Secure family accounts, recovery emails/phones, and passwords.

☐ Model respectful posting and avoid oversharing about your children.

☐ Review location sharing, public profiles, tagging, and contact lists together.

For children and teens

☐ Do not share your address, school, phone number, passwords, live location, daily schedule, private images, or codes.

☐ Do not meet someone you only know online without a parent or guardian knowing.

☐ Do not send anything you would not want shared publicly.

☐ Block and report unwanted, threatening, sexual, or inappropriate contact.

☐ Tell a trusted adult if you feel pressured, scared, confused, or uncomfortable.

☐ Do not forward harmful content, rumors, bullying, or threats.



Warning sign: If someone online asks you to keep secrets, pressures you, offers gifts, or makes you feel you are in trouble, that is a reason to **stop and tell a trusted adult**, not a reason to hide it.

Family conversation prompts

☐ "What apps or games are you enjoying right now? Show me how they work."

☐ "Who can see what you post, and who can message you?"

☐ "Has anyone online ever made you uncomfortable? What did you do?"

☐ "What would you do if a friend sent you something upsetting?"

☐ "What should we both do if someone asks for a photo or a code?"

☐ "How can I help without taking your device away?"

Our trusted adults

People a child can go to about anything online

Trusted adult	How to reach them	When to contact them

Child & Family Online Safety Guide

Smart habits, open conversations, and fast help when needed

GUIDE

Page 2 of 2

IF SOMETHING CONCERNING HAPPENS ONLINE

STOP - SAVE - BLOCK - TELL - REPORT

STOP

Stop responding if it is safe to do so. **Do not send money, photos, passwords, or personal information.**

SAVE

Save screenshots, usernames, profile links, messages, dates, platform details, threats, payment requests, and payment information.

BLOCK

Block and report the account through the platform, game, or app.

TELL

Tell a parent, guardian, trusted adult, school staff member, or another safe person.

REPORT

Call 911 for immediate danger or threats. Report suspected online child sexual exploitation to the NCMEC CyberTipline: report.cybertip.org or **1-800-THE-LOST (1-800-843-5678)**.

Evidence checklist (save before blocking, if safe)

- | | | | |
|---|--|--|---|
| ☐ Screenshots of messages and images described | ☐ Usernames and display names | ☐ Dates and times | ☐ Payment requests and details |
| | ☐ Profile links / URLs | ☐ Platform, game, or app name | ☐ Anything already sent |
| | | ☐ Threats or demands made | |

 **Do not** forward, re-share, or save copies of sexual images of a minor, even as evidence. Describe them instead and report them to the platform and the CyberTipline.

CUT OUT AND POST, OR LAMINATE

OUR FAMILY ONLINE-SAFETY PROMISE

"We can tell a trusted adult about anything online, even if we made a mistake."

WE DO NOT SHARE:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Our address or school | ☐ Phone numbers |
| ☐ Passwords or codes | ☐ Live location |
| ☐ Daily schedule | ☐ Private images |

IF SOMETHING FEELS WRONG:



Immediate danger? Call 911.

FAMILY NAME

TRUSTED ADULT PHONE